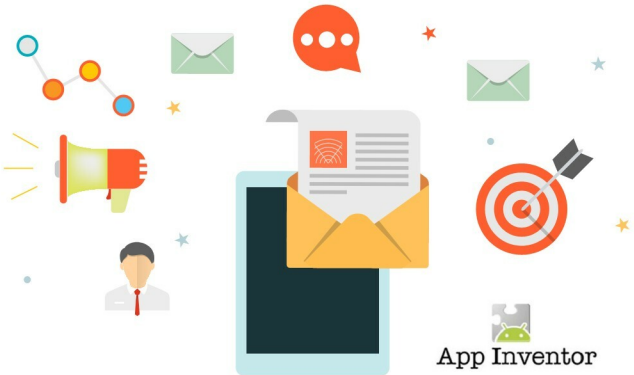


Building the Auto SMS or SMS Assistant App in App Inventor 2

This is the second article in our series on building Android apps. In this article, we'll build an app called Auto SMS or SMS Assistant, which responds to callers with a pre-composed text message about how the currently-unavailable receiver of the phone call, will call back later.



App Inventor

During the course of the day, we are involved in various activities like riding a bike, driving a car or attending a meeting, when we are not able to instantly respond to incoming messages or calls. In such situations, how can one inform the caller waiting for a response that one is currently busy but will call back later? What we need is an application that will text back informing the caller about one's current inability to take the call. So let's make an Android app that will respond to our incoming messages or calls without us touching the phone.

While developing the app in the previous issue, you got to know the various options and features available to you on the designer or block editor over the App Inventor browser application. We will be using the same tools now but with a few more components.

GUI requirements

For every application, we have a graphical user interface or GUI which helps the user to interact with the on-screen

components, and how each component responds to the user's actions is defined in the block editor section.

We will require the following components:

1. **Horizontal arrangement** - This works as a parent component for all other components which lie inside it and it ensures that each of its child components are aligned horizontally
2. **Labels** - These are the static text components which are used to display some headings or markings on to the screen
3. **Text box** - This enables the user to type anything within the box with the help of the on-screen keyboard. We can use it to get the input from the user. Here, in our case, we will let the user type anything using the text box and we will send the same text to our outgoing response messages
4. **Buttons** - These are generally action initiators. The user presses a button and a specified action takes place. In our case, when the button gets pressed, it will save the text of the text box component into the phone's local database
5. **TinyDB** - Each phone has its own database where it stores